

Library Usage Data Warehouse System

USER GUIDE

For Non-Technical Users

Version 1.0 | January 2026

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1. What is Library usage data warehouse system?

The Library Analytics System is a tool that helps you understand how students and faculty use our library services. Think of it as a dashboard for your car – instead of showing speed and fuel, it shows library usage, popular resources, and trends over time.

What Does It Do?

The system combines information from three different library systems into one easy-to-read place:

- **Book Checkouts** – Who is borrowing books and when they return them
- **Digital Downloads** – Which e-books and journals are being downloaded
- **Study Room Bookings** – When students are reserving study rooms

Why Is This Important?

Before this system, creating reports took over 15 hours of manual work each month, and the results often had errors. Now, you can:

- Get answers to important questions in seconds
- See real-time information about library usage
- Make better decisions about library resources
- Spot trends and patterns you might have missed

2. Who Should Use This Guide?

This guide is written for anyone who needs to access library reports and dashboards, including:

- **Library Directors** – Need high-level overview of library performance
- **Library Staff** – Need daily operational information
- **Department Heads** – Want to see how their department uses the library
- **Administrative Staff** – Generate reports for meetings and planning

Do I Need Technical Skills?

No! This system is designed for people without technical backgrounds. If you can use a web browser and click buttons, you can use this system. No programming or database knowledge required.

3. Getting Started

What You Need

Before you begin, make sure you have:

- **A computer with internet access** (desktop, laptop, or tablet)
- **A web browser** (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge – we recommend Chrome)
- **Your username and password** (provided by IT department)

First-Time Login

Follow these steps to log in for the first time:

10. **Open your web browser** (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Edge)
11. **Type the dashboard URL** in the address bar (contact IT if you don't have this)
12. **Enter your username** (usually your email address)
13. **Enter your password** (provided by IT department)
14. **Click 'Login'**

4. Accessing the System

Understanding Your Access Level

Different users see different information based on their role:

User Role	What You Can See	Example Tasks
Library Director	All library data across all departments and services	View executive dashboard, generate annual reports, compare departments
Department Head	Only data for your specific department	See how students in your department use library resources
Library Staff	Daily operational data (bookings, checkouts, etc.)	Check room availability, see which books are overdue

5. Using the Dashboards

The system has three main dashboards, each designed for different needs:

Executive Dashboard

Who it's for: Library directors and senior administrators

What it shows: High-level overview of library performance

Key Features:

- **Total Active Users** – See how many students and faculty used the library this month
- **Usage Trends** – Line chart showing usage over the past 3-6 months
- **Service Breakdown** – Pie chart comparing physical books, digital resources, and room bookings
- **Department Rankings** – Bar chart showing which departments use the library most

How to use it:

15. Click on 'Executive Dashboard' in the main menu
16. The dashboard loads automatically – no buttons to click!
17. Hover your mouse over charts to see detailed numbers
18. Use the date filter at the top to change the time period

Department Dashboard

Who it's for: Department heads and academic coordinators

What it shows: Detailed usage for your specific department

Key Features:

- **Department Selector** – Choose your department from a dropdown menu
- **Usage Over Time** – See how your department's usage changes month-to-month
- **Resource Preferences** – Discover whether students prefer physical books or digital resources
- **Comparison to Average** – See how your department compares to others

How to use it:

19. Click on 'Department Dashboard' in the main menu
20. Select your department from the dropdown at the top
21. The charts update automatically to show your department's data
22. Click on bars or lines in charts to see more details

Operational Dashboard

Who it's for: Library staff and front desk personnel

What it shows: Real-time information for daily operations

Key Features:

- **Today's Activity** – Live counter showing transactions happening right now
- **Room Availability** – Color-coded calendar showing which rooms are booked
- **Recent Activity** – List of the last 10 checkouts, downloads, or bookings
- **Alerts** – Notifications for overdue books or system issues

How to use it:

23. Click on 'Operational Dashboard' in the main menu
24. The dashboard refreshes automatically every 5 minutes
25. Click the 'Refresh' button to update data immediately
26. Click on any room in the calendar to see booking details

6. Common Tasks

Here are step-by-step instructions for tasks you'll do frequently:

Task 1: Check Which Departments Use the Library Most

27. Open the Executive Dashboard
28. Look for the bar chart labeled 'Department Rankings'
29. The tallest bars show the most active departments
30. Hover your mouse over a bar to see exact numbers

Task 2: See if Digital Resources Are Replacing Physical Books

31. Open the Executive Dashboard
32. Find the 'Usage Trends' line chart
33. Look at the blue line (physical books) and orange line (digital resources)
34. If the orange line is going up while blue goes down, digital is replacing physical

Task 3: Find Out When Study Rooms Are Busiest

35. Open the Operational Dashboard
36. Look at the 'Room Utilization' heatmap
37. Darker colors = busier times
38. This helps you plan when to schedule maintenance or add more rooms

Task 4: Generate a Monthly Report for Your Department

39. Open the Department Dashboard
40. Select your department from the dropdown
41. Change the date range to 'Last Month'
42. Click the 'Export' button in the top right corner
43. Choose 'PDF' or 'Excel' format
44. The report downloads to your computer automatically

Task 5: Check Today's Library Activity

45. Open the Operational Dashboard
46. Look at the big numbers at the top (these update in real-time)
47. Scroll down to see the 'Recent Activity' list
48. This shows the last 10 transactions (updates every 5 minutes)

7. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: How often is the data updated?

A: Most data updates every 24 hours (overnight). The Operational Dashboard updates every 5 minutes for real-time information.

Q: Can I download reports?

A: Yes! Every dashboard has an 'Export' button. You can download reports as PDF (for presentations) or Excel (for further analysis).

Q: Why can't I see data for other departments?

A: This is for privacy and security. Department heads can only see their own department's data. If you need access to other departments, contact the library director.

Q: What do the colors in charts mean?

A: Generally: Blue = Physical books, Orange = Digital resources, Green = Room bookings. Hover your mouse over any colored section to see what it represents.

Q: Can I see historical data from previous years?

A: Yes! Use the date filter at the top of each dashboard. You can select specific months or date ranges going back to when the system was installed.

Q: What if I see a mistake in the data?

A: Contact the library IT coordinator immediately. Include: (1) What dashboard you were using, (2) What looked wrong, (3) A screenshot if possible.

Q: Can I access this from home?

A: Yes, if you have VPN access to the university network. Contact IT for VPN setup instructions.

Q: Does this work on tablets and phones?

A: Yes! The dashboards are designed to work on any device. For the best experience, we recommend using a desktop or laptop with a large screen.

8. Troubleshooting

Problem: I Can't Log In

Try these solutions:

- Check that CAPS LOCK is off – passwords are case-sensitive
- Make sure you're typing the correct username (usually your email)
- Try resetting your password using the 'Forgot Password' link
- Contact IT Help Desk if still having trouble

Problem: The Dashboard Shows No Data

Try these solutions:

- Check your date filter – you might be looking at a time period with no activity
- Click the 'Refresh' button to reload the data
- Try closing your browser and opening it again
- If the problem continues, the data might be updating – try again in an hour

Problem: Charts Look Strange or Cut Off

Try these solutions:

- Try zooming out in your browser (hold CTRL and press minus -)
- Make your browser window bigger (maximize it)
- Clear your browser cache (ask IT how to do this)
- Try a different web browser (Chrome works best)

Problem: The Page is Loading Very Slowly

Try these solutions:

- Check your internet connection
- Close other browser tabs to free up memory
- Select a shorter date range (the system loads faster with less data)
- Try accessing during off-peak hours (early morning or late evening)

Problem: I Downloaded a Report but Can't Open It

Try these solutions:

- PDF files: Open with Adobe Reader or your browser
- Excel files: Open with Microsoft Excel or Google Sheets
- Check your Downloads folder – the file might be there

- If you don't have the right software, ask IT to install it

9. Getting Help

Who to Contact

Issue Type	Contact	Response Time
Login problems	IT Help Desk: ext. 5555 or helpdesk@university.edu	Within 1 hour
Data questions or errors	Library IT Coordinator: ext. 5556 or library.it@university.edu	Within 24 hours
How to use a feature	Library Administration: ext. 5557 or library.admin@university.edu	Within 24 hours
Request new features	Library Director: ext. 5558 or library.director@university.edu	Within 1 week

Tips for Getting Help Quickly

When contacting support, include:

- **Your name and department**
- **Which dashboard you were using** (Executive, Department, or Operational)
- **What you were trying to do**
- **What happened instead**
- **A screenshot if possible** (Press Print Screen button, then paste into email)